



GRAND SLAM TENNIS 2

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Compared to the original Wii-only predecessor, *Grand Slam Tennis* -- which was a casual cartoony affair, *Grand Slam Tennis 2* is a much more serious attempt towards giving tennis aficionados a world-class virtual tennis game to play and enjoy. Being an EA title, you know the studio will leave no stone unturned to make the game as realistic as possible. The tennis players are created with amazing visual detail- each with their individual playing styles and on-court mannerisms. You can play at all the four major tennis tournaments- Australian Open, French Open, Wimbledon and US Open- and a select few EA competitions at different locations around the world. The courts are spectacular, and the pace of game actually changes from surface to surface -- clay court games are full of rallies, while the hard court surfaces are full of games with heavy baseline shots. Forget the visual brilliance, what will keep you busy in the first few hours of *Grand Slam Tennis 2* is a whole lot of practice sessions to figure out the overhauled controls. EA calls it "Total Racquet Control" and it places a heavy impetus on the PS3 and Xbox 360 controller's right analog stick. It's a careful

combination of power and precision. Apart from a carefully placed lob and drop shots, all other strokes- flat, top spin and slices- including shot direction are fully controlled by just the right analog stick. While EA provides a classic button-enabled option, we highly recommend the new Total Racquet Control system to play virtual tennis games like never before. Sure, it does take time getting used to- heck, it's also agonizing and frustrating at times- but it's a good system. At times the dividing line between a top-spin backhand and a sliced backhand are non-existent, but such instances are few and far in between once you master the Total Racquet Control mode. Overall, EA has built a unique system that it will no doubt fine-tune in the game's next iteration. One of the greatest USPs of *Grand Slam Tennis 2* is the mix of modern greats and past legends on its roster of players. Talking about comparing players from different generations based on stats and numbers, here you can actually pit Sampras against Djokovic, McEnroe against Nadal and Sharapova against Navratilova and many more.

The game also supports Move motion controller, in case you need a good workout. Online gameplay with friends or random listed games is a fun experience as long as you're on at least a 1 Mbps connection.

Verdict

Not all is hunky dory with *Grand Slam Tennis 2*, though -- how we wish it was. Despite our thumbs up to the Total Racquet Control mode, mastering the controls is a bit difficult. We are extremely disappointed that EA didn't spend time on including a few more players (male and female) to attract greater attention and give gamers more choice. Why there isn't a likeness of such stars of the tennis world as Caroline Wozniacki, Martin Del Potro, Kim Clijsters or other more exciting players, one will never know. The in-game commentary by John McEnroe and Pat Cash is largely repetitive, which can distract you rather than immersing you in the game. *

MOAR!

- » **Developer:** EA Canada
- » **Publisher:** EA Sports
- » **Platforms:** PS3, Xbox360
- » **Price:** ₹2499 (PS3), ₹2699 (Xbox360)

